

Oxygen

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As well as making up a fifth of the air we breathe, this gaseous element also combines with metals and other substances to make many of the solid minerals of Earth's rocks. In addition, along with hydrogen, oxygen forms all the water on Earth. This is why oxygen is the most common element on Earth's surface.

ATOMIC MASS 15.999

STATE Gas

DISCOVERY 1771 (Carl Wilhelm Scheele), 1774 (Joseph Priestley; his finding was published first)

An average person
breathes in oxygen
up to 23,000
times in a day.

*Liquid oxygen is made
by cooling the air to
-183°C (-297.4°F).*

**Liquid form of
pure oxygen**